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المملكة المغربية
وزارة التربية الوطنية
والتعليم الأولي والرياضة

CRMEF MEKNES

BASIC NOTIONS AND FUNDAMENTALS OF DIDACTICS (FOUNDATIONS OF DIDACTICS 2)

DIDACTIC MODULE

Group 1

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INTRODUCTION

Many teachers find it difficult to communicate their teaching contents and transform them into abilities and skills that can be easily acquired by the learners. However, we might, by no means, be able to overcome these shortcomings unless we intend to apply the reliable findings of the recent studies that focus on transforming the scholar knowledge into teachable knowledge that foster the students' competencies and to establish the appropriate environment to boost their creative abilities and motivate them to actively acquire knowledge. No one can ignore the fact that effective teaching is not limited to the teacher's ability to master the content area of any teaching subject, but it rather, requires that the teacher should have accurate and comprehensive knowledge of the components of the teaching process. And didactics is the science that is interested in studying the interrelation of these components.

1. THE CONCEPT OF GENERAL DIDACTIC:

- **The concept of General Didactics , is a unified body of knowledge about teaching and learning can be applied in all the different disciplines . It represents the overarching theory of both decision making on and processes of teaching and learning in social institutions.**
- **General Didactic is a theoretical and practical discipline focused on the science of teaching and learning across all educational levels and contexts. It examines the fundamental principles ,structures, and conditions that govern effective teaching and learning processes, without being tied to any specific subject matter.**

2. TEACHING AND LEARNING CONTEXT:

Teaching and learning context refers to the environment, conditions, and circumstances in which education occurs. This encompasses multiple dimensions :

- Learners
- Teacher
- The content

Here are some elements to consider :

- **Physical environment**
- **Cultural context**
- **Social interaction**
- **Curricular framework**
- **Technological influence**
- **Learner characteristics and assesement & feedback**

3. SOCIAL AND COGNITIVE ASPECTS OF LEARNING EFL:

Both social and cognitive aspects play key roles in learning EFL, especially for beginners, and highlight how social and mental processes together enhance language acquisition.

SOCIAL ASPECTS:

These aspects involve interaction, communication, and cultural context. So these elements emphasize:

- Peer interaction**
- Teacher support**
- Cultural exposure**

COGNITIVE ASPECTS:

These aspects concern the internal mental processes that support learning, among which: memory and retention, attention and focus, problem solving and hypothesis, and metacognition

Social

How interaction and culture shape
language use

Cognitive

How the brain processes language

Together

Effective EFL learning happens
when mental strategies meet
authentic social practice

4. COMPETENCE:

What is Competence?

-Competence refers to a complex capacity to mobilize knowledge, skills, attitudes, and strategies in a given situation to solve a problem or perform a task.
→ It is contextual, situated, and observable through action, not just knowledge.

Its Importance:

- Guides lesson planning on context selection**
- Clarifies what learner should be able to do.**
- Allows meaningful assessment of learning**
- Links teaching to real-life situations.**

Principles of Competence:

Contextualization: Competences develop within real-life, meaningful situations that mirror authentic tasks.

Resource Mobilization: Learners activate and combine knowledge, skills, strategies, and attitudes to solve tasks.

Transfer: Learners can apply competences in new or unfamiliar situations.

Longitudinal Learning: Competence develops over time through repeated practice and increasing complexity.

Performance-Based Assessment: Competence is observable and evaluated through tasks, not only through tests.

Types of Competences:

Core/Final Competence: The main competence learners are expected to achieve at the end of a learning sequence.

- Example: Communicative competence in English: learners can describe people, places, or experiences accurately and fluently.

Transversal/Cross-Disciplinary Competence: Competences applicable across subjects or contexts.

- Example: Critical thinking, problem-solving, collaboration skills.

Types of Competences:

Specific Competence: Ensures that learners acquire an essential amount of knowledge and skills in that subject area.

- Example: Describe a person using basic grammar and vocabulary in English.

Procedural competence: Competence in applying methods, strategies, or procedures to perform tasks.

- Example: Writing a paragraph, following steps in a lab experiment, or applying grammar rules correctly.

5. OBJECTIVES:

Objectives are specific learning goals that translate competences into concrete outcomes for a lesson or activity.

They help teachers...

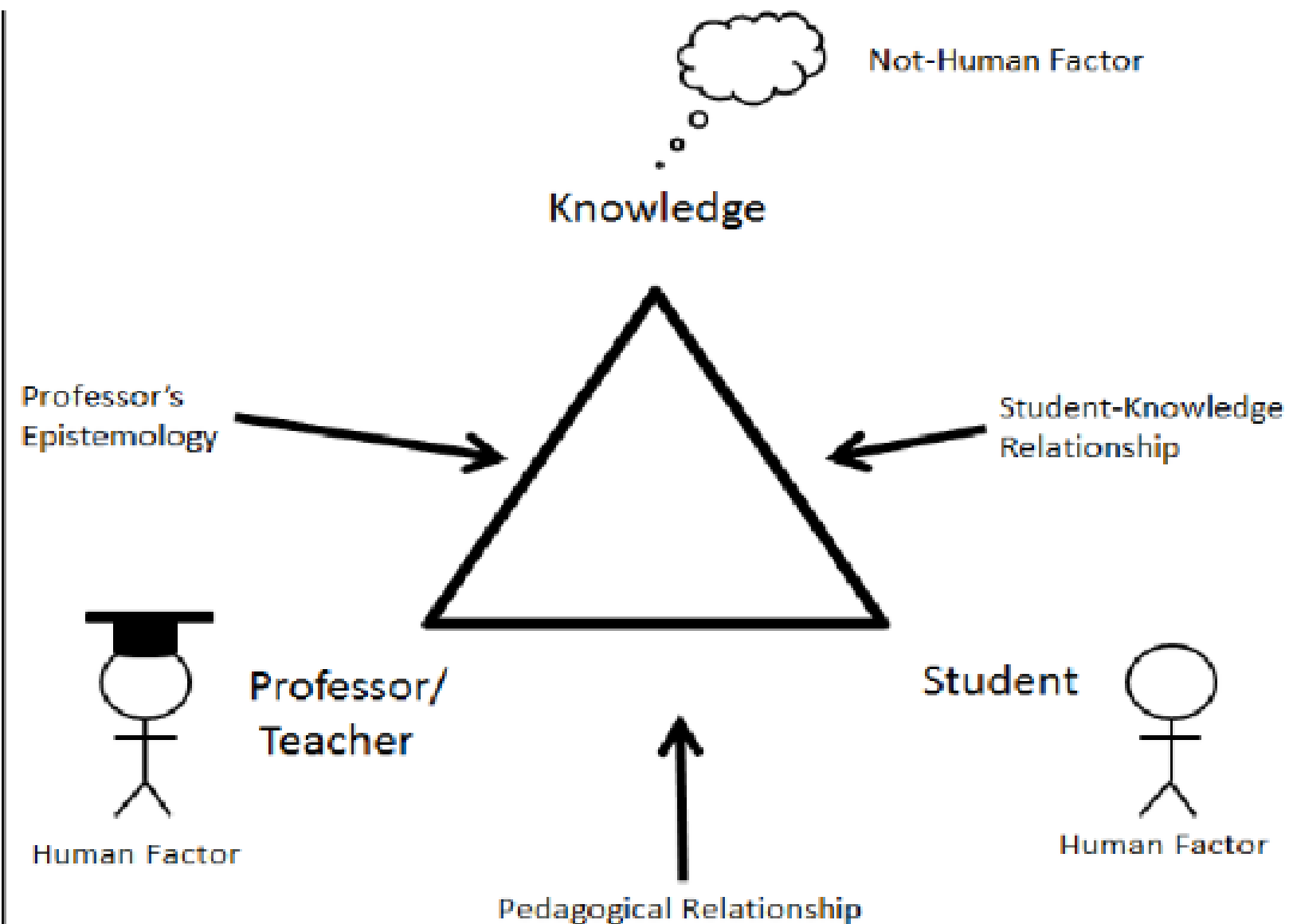
- Guide lesson planning.
- Design tasks
- Select content
- Assess learning
- Translate curriculum competences into actionable steps
- Make learning progress visible.

Characteristics of Objectives (SMART)



Specific | Measurable | Achievable | Relevant | Time-Bound

6. THE DIDACTIC TRIANGLE:



Every teaching and learning process and at any level consists of three basic factors (teacher, learner, and the content). These factors interact reciprocally forming the so-called “Didactic Triangle”.

According to Jean Houssaye, every teaching situation can be described as a triangle consisting of three main poles: knowledge, teacher and learner.

All the teaching process is based on a particular relationship between two of these three elements and the exclusion of the third with which each of the chosen elements must maintain contact (Houssaye, 1996).

7. THE TEACHING CONTRACT:

The Teaching Contract typically implies the modification of knowledge. Brousseau describes the Teaching Contract as a system of rules, mostly implicit, associating the students and the teacher, for a given piece of knowledge . This term was introduced by "Brousseau " and " Chevallard " in 1990, through which they stressed that the relationship between the teacher and the learner is tied by a set of reciprocal obligations in a didactic situation that appear in the form of behaviors based on clear rules explicitly or implicitly that are expressed. The teacher expects a set of particular responses and behaviors from the learners, and in return the learners expect a particular set of behaviors from the teacher.

What is expected from the teacher and the learner?

1- what is supposed from the teacher:

To provide structured access to the content/subject matter.

To guide and support the students in their learning journey.

To create and maintain a learning environment conducive to this interaction.

2- What is supposed from the learner:

To engage actively and willingly with the content.

To participate in the learning activities facilitated by the teacher.

To respect the shared environment and the pedagogical relationship.

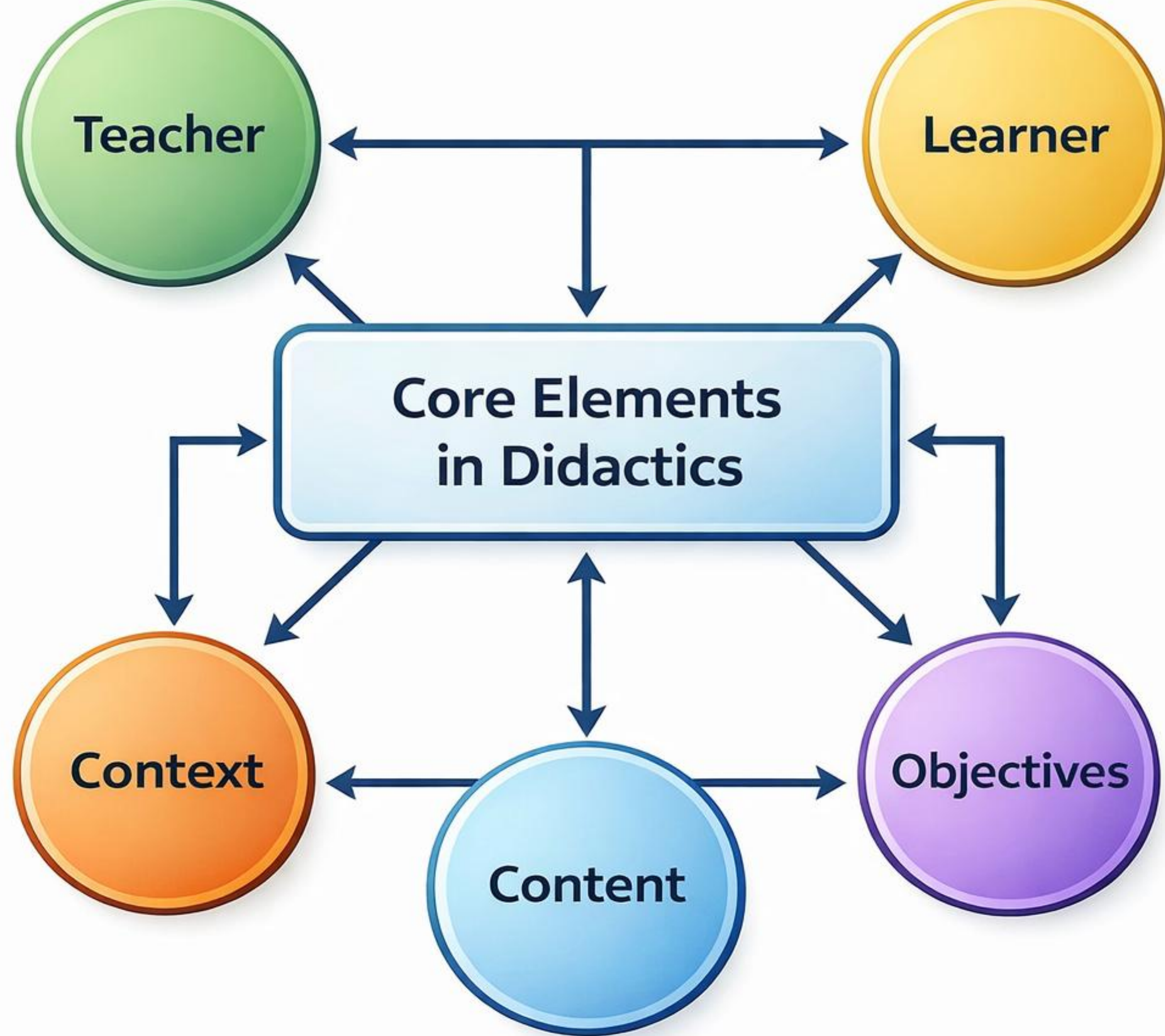
8. CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK:

What is Conceptual Framework?

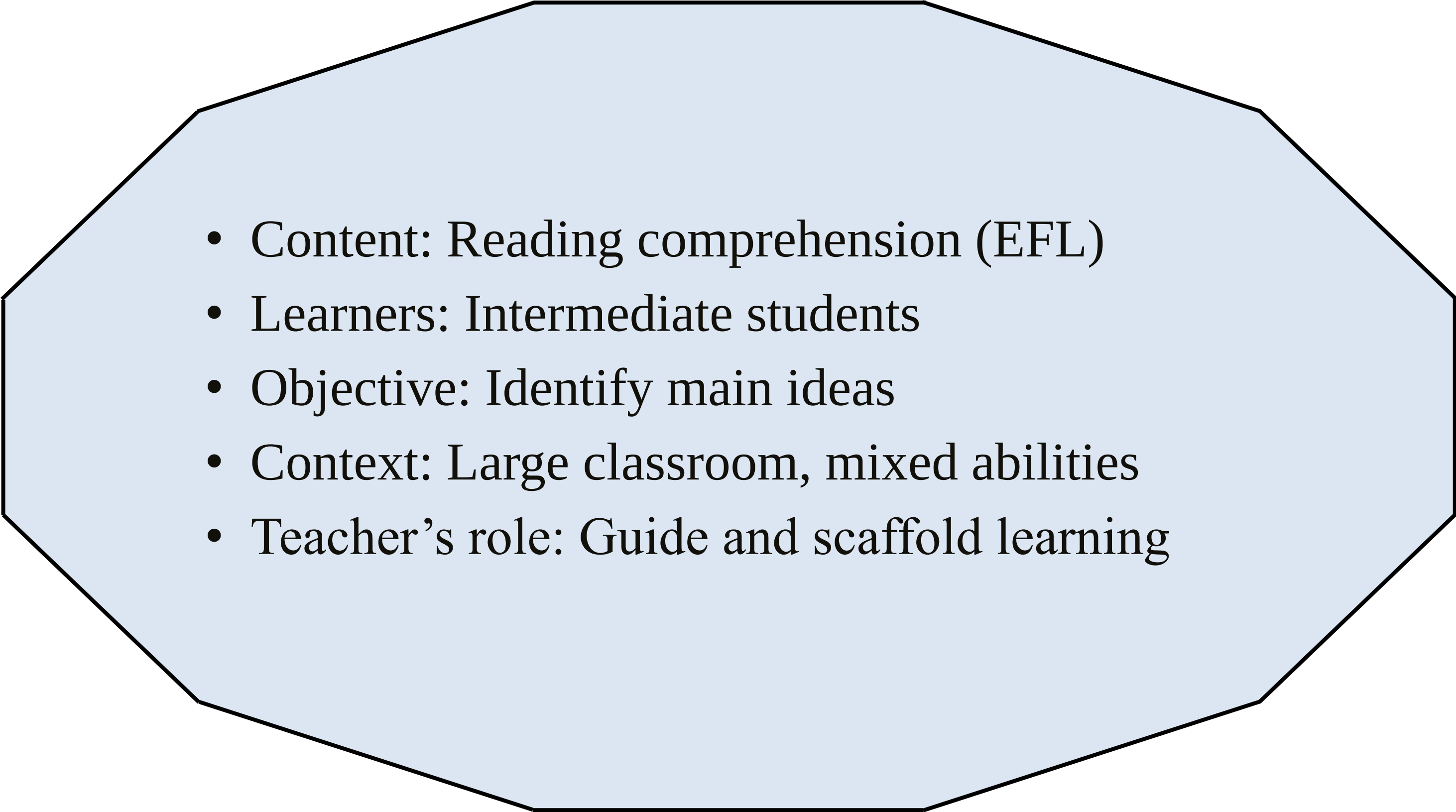
- **A structured model**
- **Shows relationships between key didactic concepts**
- **Guides teaching and learning decisions**

Its Importance

- **Gives coherence to teaching**
- **Helps plan lessons**
- **Connects theory to classroom practice**
- **Guides lesson planning**
- **Helps choose teaching methods**
- **Supports student learning**



Example..

- 
- Content: Reading comprehension (EFL)
 - Learners: Intermediate students
 - Objective: Identify main ideas
 - Context: Large classroom, mixed abilities
 - Teacher's role: Guide and scaffold learning

9. DIDACTIC TRANSPOSITION:

What is Didactic Transposition?

The notion of Didactic Transposition was first introduced by Yves Chevallard in the field of didactics of mathematics , and it refers to the transformation an object or a body of knowledge undergoes from the moment it is produced, put into use, selected, and designed to be taught until it is actually taught in a given educational institution (Chevallard ,1985, 1992).

Didactic Transposition: External and Internal Processes

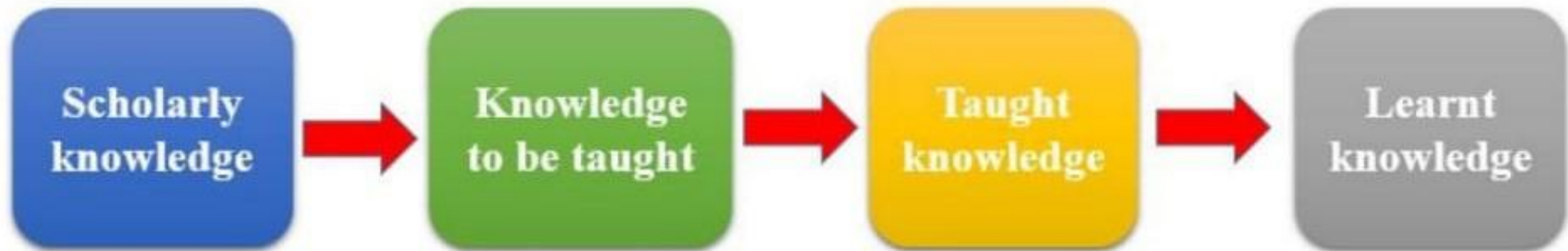
External transposition

The process of selecting, adapting, organizing and declaring the “knowledge to be taught” beginning from scholarly knowledge and ending with all the teaching materials that can be proposed in a given course (Bosch et al,2021).

Internal transposition

It refers to the process of transforming programs and syllabi or the “knowledge to be taught” into the “actually taught knowledge” in classrooms.

The Process of Didactic Transposition



Scholarly knowledge: The scientific knowledge produced by researchers and experts. It exists in universities, research articles, and academic books.

Knowledge to be taught: Knowledge is selected and organized by the ‘noosphere’—such as curriculum designers, authors, and policymakers—into official curricula and textbooks.

Taught knowledge: This is the knowledge actually presented by the teacher in the classroom. It depends on the teacher’s explanations, examples, teaching methods, and classroom constraints.

Learnt knowledge: This is the knowledge effectively understood and constructed by learners.

10. DIDACTIC SITUATION:

What is Didactic Situation?

A didactic situation, as defined by Guy Brousseau, is a carefully designed educational scenario intended to enhance learning through interaction among students, the teacher, and the subject matter. It includes a "didactic contract" that outlines implicit rules. In this framework, the teacher presents a problem (devolution) for students to tackle, promoting their active construction of knowledge through action, formulation, and validation.

Types of Didactical Situations

1. Situation of Action

Learners interact with a problem and try to find a solution through exploration and trial-and-error, without direct instruction.

2. Situation of Formulation

Learners explain and communicate the strategies they used, turning implicit ideas into explicit knowledge.

3. Situation of Validation

Learners justify and evaluate their solutions, checking their correctness through discussion.

4. Situation of Institutionalization

The teacher formalizes the learners' knowledge and links it to the official curriculum and academic concepts.

11. DIDACTIC OBSTACLES:

The Definition of Didactic Obstacles:

The word *Didactic Obstacles* refers to the obstacles that prevent access to building knowledge in good conditions, hinder the process of teaching and learning in the desired manner, and stand as a stumbling block that hinders learners' control of concepts, and prevents them from acquiring knowledge, skills, and experiences in appropriate conditions.

Types of Didactic Obstacles:

G. Brousseau (1983) identifies three types of obstacles:

Epistemological obstacles:

Preconceived ideas, mental habits, or limited prior knowledge that hinder the acquisition of new or complex knowledge.

Ontogenic obstacles:

The difficulties or barriers to learning that come from the learner themselves. For example, Cognitive limitations, psychological factors, Motivation, and interest.

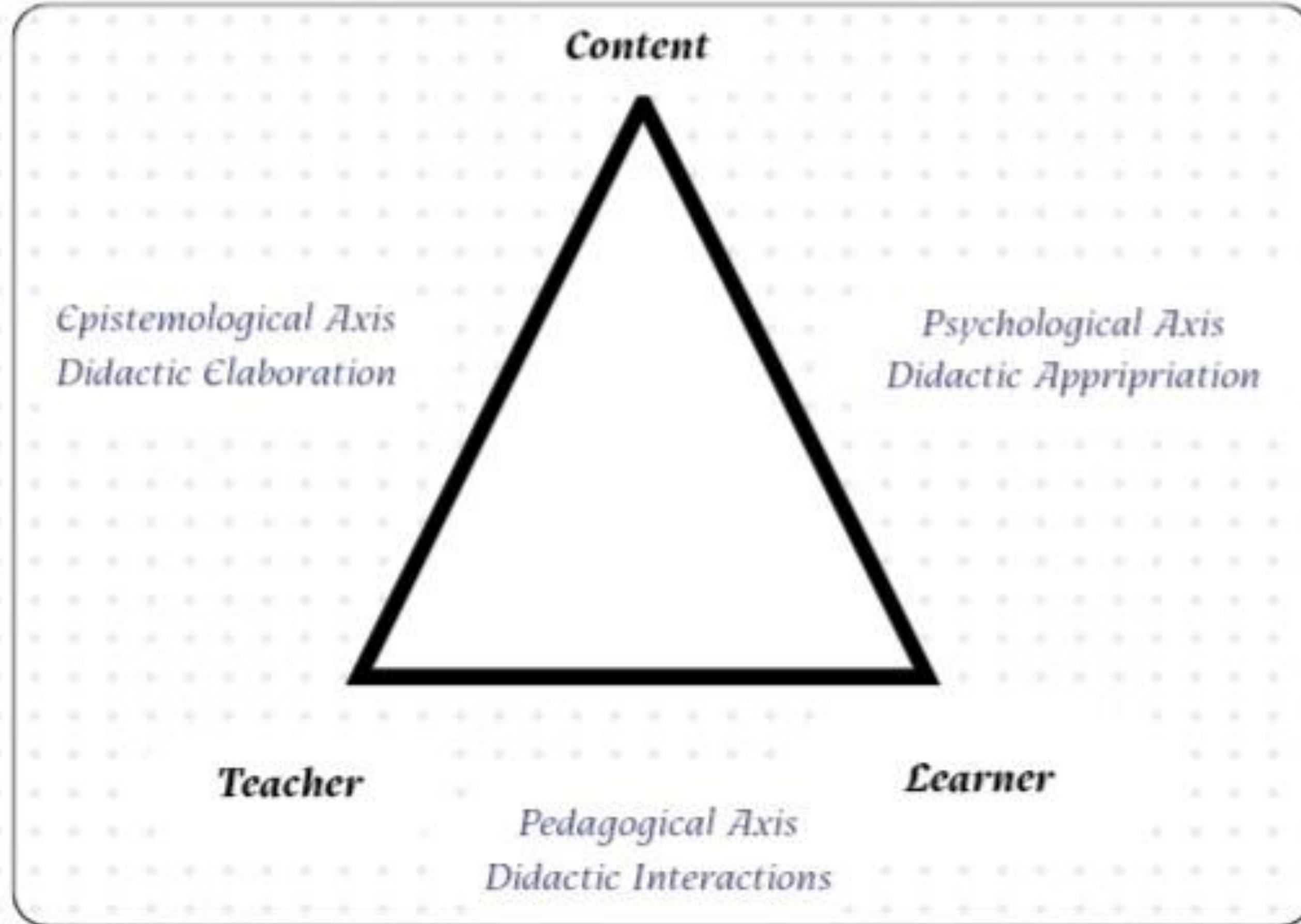
Didactic obstacles:

specific learning barriers that arise from teaching methods, pedagogical choices, and curriculum design. linked to how knowledge is selected, structured, transformed, and presented to learners.

12. THE TEACHER, CONTENT, LEARNER TRIAD:

- 1. The Teacher:* is the one guiding and supporting learning.
- 2. The Content:** is the subject matter or skills being taught.
- 3. The Learner:** is the one who is acquiring the knowledge.

The Didactic Triangle



according to J. HOUSSAYE & Y. chevallard (1985)

<i>AXIS</i>	<i>RELATIONSHIP</i>	<i>DESCRIPTION</i>
<i>The Epistemological Axis</i>	The Teacher & The Content	● Focuses on how the teacher masters the subject and prepares it for the learner.
The Pedagogical Axis	The Teacher & The Learner	● Focuses on the <u>teaching</u> process : the communication, classroom management, and support.
The Psychological Axis	The Learner & The Content	● Focuses on the <u>learning</u> process : how the learner interacts with the material.

a. TEACHER-CONTENT RELATIONSHIP:

- It acts as the first step in preparation to the teaching and learning process.
- This is where the Didactic Transposition happens, the teacher must master the content and "translate" it into a teachable format. It is a didactical relationship where the content (knowledge) is prepared to suit the learners needs.
- Teacher must continually adapt content to ensure it is relevant and accessible. This involves selecting appropriate resources and employing various teaching methods that align with learning goals and learners needs.

b. TEACHER-LEARNER RELATIONSHIP:

- The focus in this relationship is communication, classroom management, and psychological support.
- It is a didactic interaction, the teacher intervenes to facilitate, guide, and manage the Didactic Situation.
- The teacher provides guidance and scaffolding needed to help learners reach a higher level of understanding (input+1)
- it involves motivation, encouraging, and the emotional atmosphere that allows learning to happen effectively.

c. LEARNER-CONTENT RELATIONSHIP:

- It is the ultimate goal of the entire process and the teacher's role is to facilitate this specific connection.
- The learner can engage directly with the content to construct their own knowledge (provided that the two previous axis: teacher-learner, teacher-content are successful); focusing on cognitive processing, discovery, and mastery.
- This relationship identifies the learning gaps or misconceptions the learner might have: Didactic Obstacles.
- The enhancement of this relationship depends on the cognitive, social and emotional factors, as well as contextual influences and assessment strategies.

CONCLUSION:

In summary, our journey through these core concepts reveals that didactics is the art and science of managing a delicate ecosystem . The Didactic Triangle provides our fundamental map. The Didactic Triangle provides our fundamental map . The Didactic Contract is the often -unspoken constitution that makes the journey possible. The relationships helps us foster the connections that fuel motivation . And now we can view the obstacles not as walls but doors that need to be opened. Our conceptual framework is the key that unlocks this perspective. It ties it all together , transforming isolated challenges into a narrative of pedagogical practice . The ultimate goal is not to eliminate obstacles , but to develop the wisdom, within this framework, to transform them into opportunities for growth for every student.

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Thank You!